Margaret Kallus

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EDUCATION

UC Berkeley, Berkeley, CA 2021–Expected 2027
PhD Student, *Economics*

Berkeley Fellowship (2 year merit fellowship, full tuition and fees + stipend)
Stone Center Fellowship (1 semester merit fellowship, full tuition and fees + stipend)
Fields: Public economics, labor economics, health economics

Washington and Lee University, Lexington, VA 2015–2019
BS, *Mathematics and Economics, Summa Cum Laude, Honors in Economics* GPA: 3.95

Johnson Scholarship (full-ride + stipend merit scholarship); Phi Beta Kappa (inducted 2018); Kim Family Prize (top economics thesis); John McKenzie Gunn Scholarship (economics department award); Omicron Delta Epsilon Economics Honor Society; Pi Mu Epsilon Mathematics Honor Society

EXPERIENCE

Congressional Budget Office **Washington, DC**
Dissertation Fellow, Health Analysis Division June 2024–June 2026

- Work with CBO economists on projects related to Medicare access

UC Berkeley **Berkeley, CA**
Graduate Student Researcher May 2022–January 2023

- Professors Jon Kolstad and Ulrike Malmendier
- Clean and run analysis on hospital audit data (derived from individual uses of EPIC)

Opportunity Insights **Cambridge, MA**
Predoctoral Research Fellow Jun 2019–Jun 2021

- Worked as a full-time research assistant to Professors Raj Chetty, David Deming, John Friedman, and Nathaniel Hendren on both the Collegiate Leaders in Increasing MoBility (CLIMB) Initiative and the COVID-19 Economic Tracker on a team of over 30 research assistants and economists
- Compiled and merged IRS tax data, standardized testing data from ACT and College Board, and admissions data from hundreds of partner universities to study the expansion of low-income access to selective colleges
- Wrote code to scrape, clean, and analyze unemployment insurance claims data and private sector data on consumer spending, job postings, and firm closures
- Produced analysis for academic papers and media (NY Times, Wall Street Journal)

Acumen, LLC **San Francisco, CA**
Data and Policy Analyst Intern, Quality and Safety Division Jun 2018–Aug 2018

- Researched instrumental variables and power analysis for a project comparing the efficacy of flu vaccines grown in chicken eggs and those cultivated in mammalian cells
- Designed tests of potential instruments using the firm's panel of Medicare claims
- Presented findings to FDA specialists and top company economists

Washington and Lee University **Lexington, VA**
Honors Thesis in Economics Sept 2018–May 2019

- Identified the impact of fine particulate pollution on fertility using an instrumental variables design, instrumenting on county attainment status after changes to NAAQS regulations in the late 20th century

Research Assistant, *Drs. Katie Shester and Chris Handy, Economics* Jun 2017–May 2019
Research Assistant, *Dr. Irina Mazilu, Physics* Sept 2017–Jan 2018
Research Assistant, *Dr. Carrie Finch, Mathematics* Jun 2016–Sept 2016

Volunteer Positions

- Undergraduate Women in Economics Advisory Committee; Tutor (Economics, Calculus)

United States Senate **Washington, D.C.**
Senate Page Sept 2013–Jan 2014

- Appointed by Senator Kirsten Gillibrand to perform administrative duties between providing logistical support for votes and speeches on the floor of the U.S. Senate

TEACHING

Labor Economics, UC Berkeley Spring 2025
Intermediate Microeconomics, UC Berkeley Spring 2024
Introduction to Economics, UC Berkeley Fall 2023
Econometrics TA, Washington and Lee University Fall 2018, Spring 2019

PUBLICATIONS

"The Economic Impacts of COVID-19: Evidence from a New Public Database Built Using Private Sector Data." *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 2023. Raj Chetty, John N. Friedman, Nathaniel Hendren, Michael Stepner, and the Opportunity Insights Team.

"Ruth-Aaron Pairs Containing Riesel or Sierpinski Numbers," *Integers*, 2018. Elliot Edamian, Carrie Finch-Smith, and Margaret Kallus.

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Deadpooling: Strategic Adverse Selection in the Medigap Market" with Elaine Shen (JMP)

"The Price of `Free' Advice: Measuring Agency Problems in the Medicare Broker Market" with Elaine Shen

"Medigap Premiums and the Rise of Medicare Advantage" with Daria Pelech

"Insurance Agent Licensure: Turnover, Trends, and Spatial Differences"

"Personality Testing in the Hiring Process" with Hadar Avivi and Elaine Shen

GRANTS

Commonwealth Foundation: Awarded funds to support research on the Medigap and insurance agent markets (2024, $50,000)

JPAL North America: Awarded funds to run a correspondence study analyzing insurance agent recommendations in the Medicare market (2025, $50,000)

Robert Wood Johnson Foundation: Awarded funds to explore heterogeneity in a study analyzing insurance agent recommendations in the Medicare market (2025, $25,000)

UC Berkeley XLab: Awarded funds from UC Berkeley Experimental Social Science Laboratory to run a survey of Medigap plan choice (2024, $4,000)

UC Berkeley Conference Travel Grant (2025, 2026)

Understanding America Survey (UAS): Awarded free questions to understand how seniors use insurance agents and shop for Medicare plans (2025); Awarded free questions to

understand heterogeneity in senior plan shopping behaviors (2026)

PRESENTATIONS

UC Berkeley Public Seminar (2025, 2026, Berkeley CA)
UC Berkeley Labor Seminar* (2026, Berkeley CA)
UC Berkeley IO Seminar* (2026, Berkeley CA)
ASHE (June 2025, Nashville TN*; June 2026, Minneapolis MN)
ASSA (January 2026, Philadelphia PA; January 2027, Washington D.C.*)
NBER Summer Institute Workshop on Aging* (July 2026, Cambridge MA)
SITE Psychology and Economics* (September 2026, Palo Alto CA)

* presented by a coauthor

SERVICE AND VOLUNTEER

Berkeley Economists for Equity **Berkeley, CA**

- Tutoring Initiative (Co-Coordinator 2023-2024) Aug 2021–Present
- PhD Student Application Review
- Job Market Candidate Profile Review
- Student Research Grant Initiative Review

Alameda County HICAP **Berkeley, CA**

State Health Insurance Program Counselor (Volunteer) Sept 2022– Sept 2023

- Completed >50-hour training about the US Medicare and CA Medicaid systems
- Counseled local seniors about their program eligibility and coverage under different insurance plans

Project Horizon Domestic Violence and Sexual Assault Shelter **Lexington, VA**

Shelter Manager Feb 2017–May 2019

- Worked overnight managing 24-hour crisis hotline and domestic violence shelter

SELECTED TEACHING WORKSHOPS

Creating and Using Grading Rubrics
Designing Syllabi for Summer Session Courses
Syllabus and Course Design
How Students Learn

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Stata, Python, R, LaTeX, SAS, Microsoft Office Suite